Frequently Asked Questions:

Why should my child be in a Bilingual Education Program?

Numerous research studies have found that Bilingual Education focused on developing a student's bilingualism and biliteracy has lasting positive effects on educational outcomes. This is true for Emergent Bilingual students as well as Non-Emergent Bilingual Students. Studies have also found positive social benefits to learning in two languages for both groups.

Please contact the Bilingual Education, Translation & Interpretation, Community Outreach department for additional information and research. 575-527-5881

The Astounding Effectiveness of Dual Language Education for All (Collier & Thomas, 2004)
https://www.berkeleyschools.net/wp-content/uploads/2011/10/TWIAstounding_Effectiveness_Dual_Language_Ed.pdf?864d7e

A National Study of School Effectiveness for Language Minority Students' Long-Term Academic Achievement (Collier & Thomas, 2002)

https://static1.squarespace.com/static/5d854ac170e64a71d1de71d3/t/5d9de96a091ee97fc216b378/1570630038328/2002_thomas-and-collier_2002-final-report.pdf

How was my child identified as an Emergent Bilingual student?

When enrolling, all students complete a Language Usage Survey as part of the registration documents. If a guardian responds "yes" to any question on the survey, that tells us that a language other than English is part of the student's background. Once a student has a "yes" on the Survey then they are screened and if they do not reach proficiency on the screening they are identified as Emergent Bilingual students.

When is my child no longer an Emergent Bilingual student?

Once identified (through the serener), Emergent Bilingual students remain Emergent Bilingual students until they reach a 4.7 composite score on the annual ACCESS assessment.

Can I opt-out of being an Emergent Bilingual student?

Once identified (through the screener), Emergent Bilingual students remain Emergent Bilingual students until they reach a 4.7 composite score on the annual ACCESS assessment.

Can I opt-out of the ACCESS assessment?

Federal and State regulations require that Emergent Bilingual students be assessed annually until reaching proficiency on the English Language Proficiency Assessment. The State of New Mexico uses ACCESS and students need to reach a composite score of 4.7 to no longer take the assessment.

Can I opt-out of Bilingual Program once my child is enrolled?

Parents and guardians are an important part of their child's educational program. While we always encourage program participation and recognize the benefits of long-term engagement in Bilingual Programs, we understand that individual circumstances might warrant removal from the program. To begin this process please make an appointment with an administrator at the school.

What will my child's Report Card look like?

At all levels your child will receive the same report card as all other students. In Elementary school this report card will have a section for grades to be obtained in content areas in Spanish. Your child's teacher will review with you what they are grading in Spanish and English.

What does it mean if my child is an Emergent Bilingual and a student who receives Special Education Services?

Every child who receives Special Education Services has an IEP (Individualized Education Plan) so the answer to this question is different for every student. LCPS does encourage Emergent Bilingual Students who have IEPs to participate in our Bilingual Programs and in general we adhere to the following guidance:

Las Cruces Public Schools Interdisciplinary vision is to serve students with parity by prioritizing **BOTH** language and special education needs in order to provide an education where teachers and staff work in unison to achieve student success.

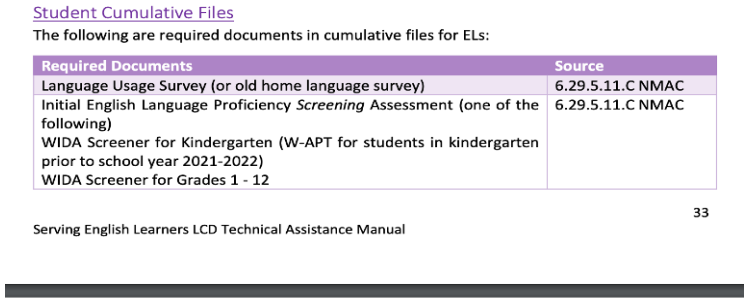
Additionally, some students who have IEPs may qualify for the Alternate ACCESS Assessment which is taken yearly in place of the ACCESS assessment. This assessment is used to measure a student's proficiency in English and if a student takes Alternate ACCESS that is determined by the IEP Team. To measure Spanish proficiency all students, take the Avant STAMP and IEP testing accommodations are followed.

Why is Parent Refusal Paperwork Completed Annually for Middle and High School Students?

State policy from the New Mexico Public Education Department Language and Culture Bureau, indicates that parents/guardians have the option to opt their student out of language support services, however the Parent Opt-Out of EB Service/Program letter needs to be signed annually (please see the screenshot below of the statement from the Language and Culture Bureau, as well as the links to the LUS Guidance Handbook and Language and Culture Bureau EBs Technical Assistance Manual).

https://webnew.ped.state.nm.us/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/LCD-ELs_TA_Manual_Rev-6.2022.pdf

https://webnew.ped.state.nm.us/wp-content/uploads/2021/07/NMLUS_Guidance_Handbook_Revised_6.2021.pdf



Student Cumulative Files

The following are required documents in cumulative files for ELs:

Required Documents	Source
Language Usage Survey (or old home language survey)	6.29.5.11.C NMAC
Initial English Language Proficiency *Screening* Assessment (one of the following) WIDA Screener for Kindergarten (W-APT for students in kindergarten prior to school year 2021-2022) WIDA Screener for Grades 1 - 12	6.29.5.11.C NMAC

33

Serving English Learners LCD Technical Assistance Manual

Required Documents	Source
Initial EL Parent Notification Letter	State Policy
Annual EL Parent Notification Letter — there should be one for each year the student has been enrolled in an EL program or service	State Policy
Annual English Language Proficiency Assessment results which include ACCESS for ELLs, Alternate ACCESS, or NMELPA for older high school students — should be one for each year the student has been an identified EL	6.29.5.11.E. NMAC
* Parent Opt-Out of EL Service/program letter—needs to be signed annually	State Policy (LUS Guidance Handbook)
For EL accommodations in the statewide student assessment system: *Written documentation of accommodation decisions made by the team shall be stored in the student's cumulative file and shall be reported to the department's bureau of assessment and evaluation.*	6.29.1.9 M.2(a)(iii) NMAC
Evidence of monitoring RFEPs (exited ELs) for academic progress for two years after student reclassified	State Policy (LUS Guidance Handbook)